Nutrients: A substance in suitable amount is essential for the growth, maintenance, function and reproduction of a cell or organism is called Nutrients. Nutrients consist of carbohydrates, fats, proteins, Vitamins and Minerals.

Macronutrients: Proteins, carbohydrates, and fats are called macronutrients. It supply energy in large quantities to the body and build tissues.

Micronutrients: Vitamins and minerals are called micronutrients. It is needed in small quantity but they play a crucial role to regulate and control body processes.

Malnutrition: Malnutrition is an impairment of health resulting from a deficiency, excess or imbalance of nutrients. It includes under nutrition and over nutrition.

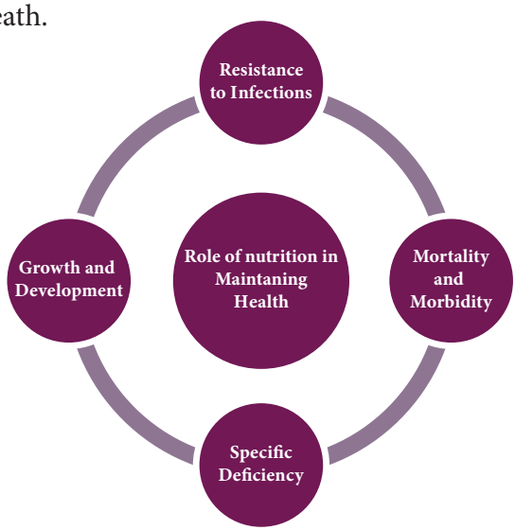
Metabolism: Metabolism is the sum total of building up reactions (anabolism) and breakdown reactions (catabolism) going on inside the body of a living organism.

5.2 Classification of Food

1. Classification by origin
    - Foods of animal origin
    - Foods of plant origin.
2. Classification by chemical composition
    - Protein
    - Fats
    - Carbohydrates
    - Vitamins
    - Minerals
3. Classification by predominant function
    - Body building foods: milk, meat, poultry, fish, egg, pulses, peanuts etc.,
    - Energy giving food: cereals, sugars, roots and tubers, fats and oils.
    - Protective foods: vegetables, fruits and milk.

5.3 Role of nutrition in maintaining health

Nutrition is a basic element of health. Nutrition influence the health from birth to death.



Growth and development

- Good nutrition is essential for attainment of normal growth and development during fetal life and childhood. Physical growth, intellectual development, learning and behavior are affected by malnutrition.
- Adequate nutrition is needed for adult life maintenance for optimum health and efficiency.
- Elder people needs special nutrition due to their physiological and chronological changes. Pregnant and lactating mothers require more proteins and nutrients to prevent abortion, growth retardation and low birth weight babies and provide adequate breast feeding for their babies.

Specific deficiency diseases

- The most common deficiencies find in Indians are Protein energy malnutrition, blindness, goiter, anemia, beriberi, rickets etc. There is increased incidence of abortion, prematurity, still birth and low birth weight babies in malnourished mothers.

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